

**After Action review
of UNDP corporate response
to the crisis in Haiti
2024 - 2025**

FINAL REPORT

July 2026

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Executive Summary

This internal After-Action Review (AAR) of UNDP's corporate response to the Haiti crisis in 2024, is a structured reflection that helps the organization identify strengths and weaknesses and learn from experience. It covers the period of the activation of corporate support as a Level 3 (L3) crisis, from March 2024 to May 2025.

To examine UNDP's response to the crisis, three primary aspects were reviewed:

- Overall clarity and timeliness of decision-making for the response
- Timeliness & effectiveness of programmatic response and the use of Corporate Funds
- Effectiveness of the operational response (Staffing capacity, SURGE, operations)

The crisis response in Haiti demonstrated the value of UNDP's corporate mechanisms for rapid action, particularly through the L3 crisis declaration, which enabled timely decision-making, strengthened coordination, and expanded technical and financial support. Collaboration among the Country Office (CO), Regional Bureau of Latin America and the Caribbean (RBLAC) and the Crisis Bureau (CB) ensured adaptive and responsive engagement. Support through SURGE deployments was assessed as technically effective.

The transition from L3 to the protracted crisis category in May 2025 highlights the need for continued structured support arrangements to sustain operational momentum. The protracted category provides a framework for continued engagement and should be defined more specifically to ensure continued corporate attention and operational readiness.

The Rapid Crisis Impact Assessment (RCIA) continues to show strong potential as a standard tool for rapid analysis, donor outreach, and program pipeline development. As part of institutionalization, finalizing joint guidance will strengthen its positioning and usability in future crises.

In Haiti, the potential for stabilization remains contingent on improved security conditions and robust political commitments. UNDP's investments in preparedness—including remote sensing and 3D mapping—offer valuable tools for both Haiti and other conflict-affected contexts. A political agreement might be foundational for further engagement.

To sustain progress, key recommendations include prioritizing stabilization as UNDP's central programmatic entry point once conditions allow; ensuring continued corporate support under the protracted category through integrated mechanisms; strengthening procurement and HR systems for protracted crises contexts; expanding special measures; and enhancing political-level visibility, including through potential senior leadership visits.

1. Objective, scope and methodology of the AAR

1.1 Objective and scope

Guided by the Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) on Crisis Response, UNDP conducts After Action Reviews (AARs), following a crisis response activation, to learn from the experience and inform its approach to crisis response. The AAR documents lessons learned and offers a reflection that helps the organization to identify strengths and weaknesses, as well as sustain what was done well and identify areas for improvement. This AAR analyses UNDP's corporate response to the conflict in Haiti. It covers the **activation of the corporate response from March 2024 to May 2025**.

1.2 Methodology

To examine UNDP's response to the crisis, three dimensions have been considered to understand the programmatic and operational response to the crisis:

1. Overall Clarity and Timeliness of Decision Making for the Response
2. Timeliness and Effectiveness of Programmatic Response and the use of Corporate Funds
3. Effectiveness of the Operational Response (Staffing capacity, SURGE, Procurement and Operations)

The review of the three dimensions considers the effectiveness of UNDP's coordination and communication approaches as well as the entry points for resource mobilization.

The review is an UNDP internal process. It is based on qualitative data collection that includes a desk review of relevant UNDP internal documentation, focused on those prepared during the corporate response period and related to corporately institutionalized processes (Crisis Boards/CMSTs), as well as selected remote Key Informant Interviews (KII).

The present report is the result of the analysis conducted, reviewing relevant documentation and incorporating views of key UNDP staff involved in the response. It offers reflections on UNDP performance in the crisis response, followed by recommendations to strengthen the corporate crisis preparedness and response.

2. Country situation

2.1 Context and background

Over the years, Haiti has faced a chronic crisis of political legitimacy. Since the fall of the Duvalier dictatorship in 1986, the country struggled to establish durable, credible governance. Elections have frequently been disputed or incomplete.

Instability deepened after the assassination of President Jovenel Moïse in July 2021, at his private residence in Port-au-Prince, by a group of foreign mercenaries and Haitian accomplices. The killing ended an already contested presidency and plunged Haiti into a deep political vacuum. With no functioning parliament and no clear constitutional succession mechanism, governance authority became highly disputed, state authority was undermined, and public trust eroded, creating space for armed actors to emerge as alternative power holders. Throughout 2022, Haiti remained without any elected national officials, as political negotiations over a transitional framework stalled. Prime Minister Henry governed by executive authority amid growing opposition from civil society groups, many of whom questioned both his legitimacy and capacity to lead a transition to elections. Security conditions deteriorated sharply. Gangs consolidated control over key roads, ports, and fuel terminals around Port-au-Prince, crippling the economy and disrupting humanitarian aid. Faced with spiraling violence, Haiti requested the deployment of an international security force that was agreed in 2023 under Kenyan leadership.

1.2 Overview of events in 2024-2025

In this context, accelerated gang-controlled violence and gang dominance in 2024 led to a governance and security collapse. In April 2024, Prime Minister Ariel Henry resigned following intense domestic and international pressure, amid coordinated gang attacks that effectively paralyzed the capital. Through meticulously orchestrated simultaneous assaults against police and critical infrastructure (port control), gangs facilitated the escape of over 4,600 inmates. Haiti was placed under a Transitional Presidential Council (TPC), tasked with governing until elections could be organized. Starting in June 2024, a Kenya-led Multinational Security Support (MSS) mission deployed to Haiti under UN Security Council authorization to support the overwhelmed Haitian National Police and help secure critical infrastructure.

By 2025, Haiti's crisis had entered a more entrenched phase, characterized by the consolidation of gang power, the continued fragility of transitional governance, and limited gains from international security assistance. Although the TPC remained formally in charge, it struggled to assert authority amid persistent allegations of corruption, internal divisions, and an inability to deliver tangible improvements in security or daily life. Planned steps toward elections were repeatedly delayed.

In September 2025, the UN Security Council authorized the establishment of the **Gang Suppression Force (GSF)** to replace the Kenya-led **Multinational Security Support (MSS) Mission**, reflecting international recognition that the scale and sophistication of gang violence in Haiti required a more robust security response. The GSF was mandated to work in close coordination with the Haitian

National Police and the Armed Forces of Haiti to conduct intelligence-led operations against armed gangs, secure critical infrastructure, facilitate humanitarian access, and support broader efforts to restore state authority and public security. The transition from the MSS to the GSF was intended to address the MSS's operational limitations, including chronic underfunding and insufficient personnel, while maintaining international support to Haitian security institutions.

Humanitarian indicators in 2025 reached some of their worst levels in decades. By midyear, more than half of Haiti's population faced acute food insecurity, and over one million people were internally displaced.

3. Analysis of the UNDP response

3.1 UNDP in-country structure and response capacity

At the time of crisis, UNDP in Haiti was present in three areas in line with its 2023-2027 Country Programme, also reflected in the UNSCDF: Governance, Poverty Reduction, and Resilience. Most of the efforts were focused on governance, given the security situation. UNDP worked closely with the United Nations Integrated Office in Haiti (BINUH) leading flagship programmes on strengthening the police, justice sector reform and elections, as key enablers for development. UNDP was implementing a multi donor programme to address the urgent need for internal reforms and capacity building within the Haiti National Police. UNDP further supported the Ministry of Justice and Public Security and the Superior Council of the Judiciary to implement the Program for Justice Support and Fight Against Impunity. On stabilization, UNDP was ready to deploy a dedicated team focused on assessing the feasibility of an integrated stabilization programme in Haiti.

3.2 UNDP corporate response

In 2024, the decision for the L3 declaration was taken timely, effectively, and in line with UNDP's SOPs for Crisis Response. Strong and effective relations between RBLAC, the CO, and the Crisis Bureau helped with rapid decision making. These were highly valued as they allowed brainstorming and thinking through approaches jointly. Response support was seen as ready, rapid, effective, and highly valuable. Technical support enabled UNDP CO preparedness and positioning.

Throughout the crisis response, the Regional Gender Team, in close coordination with the HQ Gender Team, provided continuous technical advisory support to the Haiti Country Office. This included quality assurance of programme documents and crisis-response proposals, support to Gender Marker application, strategic advice during programme design and revisions, contributions to resource mobilization efforts, and technical guidance to strengthen the integration of gender equality considerations across governance, stabilization and, livelihoods. This support also contributed to strengthening the Country Office's capacities through the Gender Equality Seal process and broader efforts to advance gender-responsive programming. UNDP delivers large portfolios in crisis contexts. While UNDP's decision-making in a crisis situation is speedy and effective, a concern was raised regarding UNDP's agility and speed related to operational procedures for implementation.

3.3 Clarity and Timeliness of Decision Making for the Response

Jointly with RBLAC, the Crisis Bureau support to the Haiti Country Office has been a priority for multiple years, with a focus on technical expertise and financial resources in response to a protracted context, repositioning and sudden-onset crises. In 2021, RBLAC and CB declared a L2 crisis in response to the earthquake in the country.

Continuous funding support was provided to the CO through TRAC3, the Rule of Law Global program, and Funding Window resources. In the CB-RBLAC strategic dialogue held in July 2022, Haiti was affirmed as a priority country and leadership agreed to strengthen the prevention focus and conduct an Out of Fragility analysis (OoF in 2022), in line with the new Crisis Bureau SOP and the new Crisis

Offer. CB and RBLAC set up a Country Support Group that devised a multi-year support plan including financial and targeted capacity support.

The L3 was declared in this context in 2024. On 24 March 2024, Haiti was classified an L3 crisis, triggering corporate support and Special Measures, including USD 200,000 “no-regrets” funding and USD 1 million for immediate programming (based on UNDP’s Crisis Response SOP). The crisis elevated and refocused broad corporate support to Haiti, it further ensured availability of corporate support structures to the Country Office and visibility in a tense and deteriorating environment.

The first Crisis Board underlined the imperative of staff security and duty of care and asked RBLAC and BMS to ensure staff security as well as identify ways to support National Staff through residential security measures or relocation grants to safer locations in the country.

In terms of capacities, CO capacities were assessed as adequate, with potential for operations reinforcement. In 2023, the CO reached a delivery of USD 39.8 million (110%), with 159 National Staff and 14 International Staff working for UNDP in Haiti. In addition to staff based in Port au Prince, the CO had staff based at UNDP Offices in Fort Liberte (6), Jeremie (14) and Les Cayes (4). Six internationals were still working from Haiti.

In terms of programming, and despite the highly challenging circumstances, the CO was increasing the support to the Haitian National Police and was actively engaged in discussions with various partners, including BINUH, to develop a program aimed at supporting the transition process.

As key entry point, the Crisis Board agreed for UNDP to assess the feasibility of implementing a stabilization programme to accompany the efforts of the Multinational Security Support (MSS) mission in securing targeted areas. A scoping mission was deployed in January 2024 and the Crisis Board agreed on deployment of a stabilization SURGE capacity to advance this.

Crisis Bureau diligently followed its Crisis Response SOP and held a CMST on 5 November 2024 to prepare for a second Crisis Board in December 2024 that extended the L3 for 6-months, and a final Crisis Board closed the L3 crisis in May 2025.

With the closure of the L3 crisis, Haiti was moved to the protracted category status based on the Crisis Response SOP. This transition to the protracted status raised questions by RBLAC and the CO regarding the status, possibly reduced availability of resources and less corporate attention. They underlined that senior-level focus continues to be necessary.

A whole of UNDP approach was followed during the response to the Haiti crisis. UNDP’s structures and processes that were followed brought together relevant bureau in the three Crisis Boards and the CMST. CB’s C3RT Regional Team ensured integrated engagement between the boards under the leadership of RBLAC. Given the tense security situation, BMS was closely engaged related to duty of care, specifically for national staff, and the agreement to special measures for crisis response. BERA did engage in corporate processes, however opportunities for strategic corporate communications and resource mobilization remained limited in a tense environment.

3.4 Effectiveness of Programmatic response and use of Corporate Funds

CO programmatic implementation was affected by the security situation, and stabilization programming during the L3 phase was challenged by the ongoing violence. Relevant preparatory work on stabilization could however advance, which provided the CO with the necessary tools to engage once feasible. Corporate funds were allocated following the L3 declaration. Given the challenges for immediate programming, accessing the USD 1.2 million TRAC 3 allocation was delayed. The 2023 Funding Window (FW) allocation available to the CO was redirected in 2024. Re-accessing the FW funds again in 2025 for Haiti CO required renewed proposal development, which slowed down rapid funding availability for the CO in responding to government requests.

Stabilization

Accelerating the stabilization programme was identified as key programmatic opportunity for UNDP in the first Crisis Board in March 2024. The Crisis Board tasked the Crisis Bureau, RBLAC and the CO to explore options and the Crisis Bureau's Stabilization Team deployed a planning mission and a Senior Stabilization consultant in July 2024 to assist in ascertaining the appropriateness of the stabilization approach. A project document and a Country Office Stabilization Readiness Plan were formulated. This followed a high-level scoping mission for stabilization programming, which proceeded in January 2024 before the crisis.

The Crisis Bureau responded quickly to the Country Office's request to create a stabilization programme aligned with the deployment of the Multinational Security Support (MSS) mission and later the Gang Suppression Force (GSF). The rapid technical support was appreciated by the CO, in terms of preparedness and the usage of innovative tools such as satellite data and 3D drone scanning, allowing a better understanding of the unique situation and stabilization in an urban setting. The technical support team was able to adapt the approach from other contexts (e.g., Lake Chad Basin, Iraq, and Nigeria) to Haiti's gang-controlled environment with the aim of advancing UNDP civilian stabilization measures in areas liberated from gangs by GSS, the Haitian National Police and Armed Forces of Haiti. ().

Technical exchanges undertaken during the preparation phase also highlighted the importance of integrating inclusive governance and women's economic empowerment perspectives into stabilization thinking, recognizing their potential contribution to community resilience, social cohesion and longer-term recovery whenever security conditions permit. Implementation of the stabilization approach stalled as the required security conditions never materialized. Gangs continued to control key areas, and MSS forces were insufficient and focused mainly on securing infrastructure (airports, key routes). The needed political compact was missing: coordination among Haitian authorities, MSS, and international actors (US, Kenya, Canada) was weak. Without guarantees that cleared areas would be held by security forces, UNDP could not safely deploy stabilization activities. Some resources were mobilized (USD 3 million from Korea), but sustainable donor championing (e.g. Germany in other contexts) was absent, leaving a gap in political advocacy.

As it stands, a stabilization entry point exists with focus on the Port-au-Prince downtown area vacated by gangs, with UNDP ready to support police presence and launch quick-impact activities

(temporary posts, cash-for-work, service restoration). Short-term political instability (e.g., gang threats, government transition) continues to delay action. DDR planning has emerged as an important area of engagement, with Member States, BINUH, and UN entities exploring coordinated approaches to support future dismantlement and exits from gangs.

The L3 declaration mobilized corporate support to stabilization. The CB team was on standby, and the Crisis Board ensured rapid engagement. Special Measures helped accelerate corporate processes and procurement support was deployed, however the need was raised to consider scope for additional operations support in crisis contexts and long-time protracted settings to ensure UNDP agility in crisis and fragile situations.

Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment

Throughout the crisis response, the Regional Gender Team, in coordination with the HQ Gender Team, supported the Haiti Country Office to integrate gender equality across crisis response, stabilization, governance, livelihoods and recovery.

Gender expertise informed Crisis Board discussions, senior management briefings and Country Office consultations, maintaining attention to risks facing women and girls, Gender Marker performance and gender-responsive resource allocation.

Technical assistance strengthened TRAC3, Funding Window and other proposals through quality assurance, improved results frameworks, Gender Marker guidance and stronger entry points for women's participation, leadership and economic empowerment. This improved proposal quality, alignment with corporate standards and opportunities for GEN2 and GEN3 programming.

Support also contributed to stabilization planning, the Haiti Gender Equality Seal baseline assessment and Crisis Track, and the Haiti Gender Equality Strategy. These processes promoted inclusive local governance, women's participation in recovery decisions and women's economic empowerment as key elements of resilience and recovery.

Overall, the combined support strengthened Country Office capacity, programme quality, resource mobilization and alignment with corporate gender standards.

Use of innovative tools in a protracted situation

Following the first Crisis Board the security situation remained fluid, and UNDP decided to prepare relevant programmatic entry points and be ready to engage when the situation allowed. Crisis Bureau C3RT assessment team supported the Haiti Country Office with preparedness analysis for stabilization efforts. Given lack of physical access to many neighborhoods due to gang control, the goal was to provide evidence-based insights for decision-making. The team used 3D Mapping & Remote Sensing Analysis and high-resolution remote sensing (drone) imagery to evaluate the

conflict-related damage to buildings and infrastructure as well as rubble, debris, and street barricades. This resulted in a detailed neighborhood-level damage assessment. A mobile-based citizen survey was used to build a multi-dimensional vulnerability and social cohesion index.

The drone-based assessments were extremely useful for better understanding inaccessible conflict settings and simultaneously required sensitive handling of the process and terminologies. They were valuable for detailed information and helped together with remote sensing, satellite proxies and mobile surveys to capture different levels of a situation. While they were technically complex and costly, the strong CO leadership was critical for its success.

RCIA- Rapid Crisis Impact Assessment

The RCIA was piloted in Haiti as a rapid, joint assessment mechanism designed to provide actionable insights within 3–4 months. RCIA is short, focused, and iterative, enabling quick decision-making and donor engagement. The joint assessment enhanced credibility, donor alignment, and informed program design. It enabled UNDP positioning among other institutions as well as generated critical data for decision-making and informed new project proposals aligned with donor priorities.

The formal request from the Ministry of Finance defined the scope and timeline of the exercise. Building on this mandate, UNDP, the World Bank, the European Union, and the Inter-American Development Bank aligned roles and a shared methodology. The assessment was rapidly designed to concentrate on Port-au-Prince and the most affected regions, keeping the geographic focus deliberately limited to enable speed. Data collection and analysis proceeded across multiple pillars, with UNDP leading the Rule of Law, Justice, and Security pillar. Findings were consolidated into a recovery framework that provided cost estimates for each pillar and was designed for iterative updates. A donor conference was ultimately canceled due to insecurity, which constrained traction.

The RCIA in Haiti achieved significant results within a compressed timeline. Delivered in just four months, it met the government's urgent request for rapid insights and demonstrated that a joint mechanism can function effectively in a volatile environment. The process produced a Recovery Framework with detailed cost-based priorities, offering a clear roadmap for dialogue. It marked a milestone by securing the participation of the Inter-American Development Bank for the first time in such an exercise, broadening the coalition for recovery planning. UNDP's leadership on the Rule of Law and Security pillar reinforced the Country Office's strategic positioning and ensured that technical contributions aligned closely with operational priorities. The EU and the IADB did indicate interest in UNDP's stabilization proposal.

Deployments

A technical stabilization planning mission was deployed to the country for stabilization programme development in July 2024. This was followed by a 3-month deployment of a senior SURGE Advisor who supported the RCIA process and continued the stabilization work. The advisor's expertise was highly appreciated and well-integrated in CO processes and supported by CO Senior Management. Crisis Bureau provided strong, proactive support throughout the mission, which enabled smooth operations.

Deployment of a procurement specialist for six months to support implementation of special measures. The deployment was remote due to security concerns. This Operations deployment was the only operations related deployment in the crisis response, despite a recommendation in the second Crisis Board for strengthening the operations unit. Given the operational challenges some interviewees indicated, additional operations support could have been helpful during the L3 response phase.

3.5 Effectiveness of the Operational Response

Duty of Care

While the broader situation in Haiti had been challenging for years with continuous instability since 2018, the situation in 2024 became acute and the L3 activation in March 2024 was triggered by the political vacuum. For UNDP corporately, it elevated the duty-of care concerns for staff due to airport shutdowns and increasing gang control.

The L3 declaration and the Crisis Board created political momentum to address staff concerns for security and mental wellbeing.

The final Crisis Board on 8 May 2025 highlighted a continuously challenging security situation. Due to gang-related threats, the main office had been relocated to a secure facility. The CO was discussing further relocation. Staff were operating under a hybrid model: two days in office, the rest remotely. Satellite communications (Starlink) were being used to ensure connectivity. Emergency preparedness included provision of sofa beds in field offices, SSAFE and IFAK training, and contingency clearances. As the support to the Haiti CO moved from L3 to protracted status it was clear that duty of care remained critical for UNDP corporately in Haiti.

Human Resources

During the crisis response phase, no specific decisions on human resources were triggered by the Crisis Board. However, the CO did assess that this might be relevant for UNDP related to duty of care. In protracted contexts, staff sometimes operate in crisis duty stations for multiple years with a significant impact on wellbeing, mental health and performance. In some cases, a review of staff structure may be needed with efficient support options to ensure CO readiness.

Special Measures

The Haiti CO benefitted from the pre-approved Special Measures that were triggered by a L3 crisis declaration. This was highly appreciated by the CO and considered very relevant to ensure agility. The key focus areas were recruitment and HR strengthening, procurement and contract management, as well as risk management. BMS confirmed the approval of requested special measures in the second Crisis Board on 18 December 2024, and they were extended beyond the L3 closure up until 31 December 2025.

From CO perspective, the special measures linked to the L3 are crucial and an important achievement. The CO argued that the existing special measures are useful but may even be expanded. Specifically, the procurement ceiling of USD 300k was assessed insufficient for Haiti's

crisis context as were some Human Resources standards that continue to pose challenges in crisis contexts (for example availability of documentation for applicants).

While a L3 and accompanying Special Measures offers helpful support, there might be scope for UNDP to further analyze how to ensure agility and effective implementation in a crisis response or protracted situation.

4. Communications and Resource Mobilization

With the escalation of the crisis, UNDP decided to keep a lower profile on communication, specifically due to the sensitivity of UNDP's work with the national police. Under guidance from RBLAC, UNDP aimed at achieving a balance between visibility but keeping direct crisis communication limited. Caution was further advised towards the end of the L3 period to foster a one UN approach in the country.

A UNDP senior level visit, possibly by the Associate Administrator, was contemplated during the L3 phase but did not materialize in 2025. The visit finally took place in March 2026, by the new Administrator, and was well received by the Government. During the visit, the Administrator met with the Prime Minister and other political and business leaders, reaffirming UNDP's commitment and future support for the electoral process.

The CO successfully raised USD 3 million from Korea for stabilization programming and was overall able to maintain its portfolio of USD 60 million delivery annually. Specific resource mobilization entry points based on the RCIA and continuous stabilization engagement remained limited given the security situation. During the final Crisis Board, the Associate Administrator suggested developing donor-facing materials and impact narratives to mobilize political and financial support.

5. Lessons Learned and Recommendations

Lessons Learned

- **Effective Use of L3 Declaration:** The L3 crisis declaration enabled rapid and timely decisions aligned with UNDP's Crisis Response SOPs and strengthened corporate support on stabilization. Strong relations between RBLAC, the CO, and the Crisis Bureau facilitated adaptive and responsive support, providing the flexibility required in a crisis context.
 - The L3 declaration created **visibility** for the crisis at the senior management level, which helped strengthen visibility with partners and boost staff morale.
 - UNDP's **technical engagement** was sound, and the organization responded to relevant programmatic needs of the CO.
 - Corporate **funding allocations** for the response follow specific regulations that often require immediate expenditure. In challenging security situations, greater flexibility in the use of these funds may offer different options to the CO.
 - **Special Measures:** Implementation of special measures was highly appreciated as an important step for the organization. However, stakeholders emphasized the need to further strengthen UNDP's agility in crisis contexts by enhancing Country Office flexibility and rapid responsiveness. In this regard, existing special measures could be analyzed and potentially expanded for high-risk and protracted crises contexts.
- **L3 closure and move to protracted category:** A L3 crisis declaration offers specific funding, capacity and technical support to a CO. The closure, decided at the Crisis Board, required preparatory communication with the Regional Bureau and the CO to preempt potential uncertainty around continued support in protracted situations.
 - The protracted category provides a framework for supporting Country Offices through dedicated capacities, technical support and potential funding.
 - Haiti CO was moved to the protracted category with L3 closure. In the final Crisis Board meeting, the recommendation for continued support remained quite broad without specific recommendations.
 - UNDP delivers large portfolios in protracted crisis contexts. It is important for UNDP to be agile and ensure CO operational effectiveness in high-risk environments.
 - UNDP may further analyze needs for COs operating in fragile and protracted situations to ensure their ability for rapid action, implementation and effectiveness.
- **SURGE Deployment:**
 - SURGE deployment was assessed as effective with technically sound support deployed to the CO.
 - The need to enforce deployment protocols was emphasized and the rapid release of staff needs to be ensured for staff members who are part of the SURGE pool.
 - Despite challenges raised around CO operations process, only one SURGE deployment for Operations was requested (Procurement Specialist).

- **RCIA Institutionalization and Donor Engagement:**

- The RCIA has the potential to become a standard rapid assessment tool linked to fast-track programme pipelines. Its joint approach helps prevent duplication and conflicting data, improves credibility, and can strengthen programme design. Finalizing the joint guidance note would further institutionalize roles, methodologies and approaches for future crises.
- Post-assessment engagement gap: UNDP needs stronger visibility with a clear plan for donor engagement and political outreach.
- Context matters: Political instability and donor fatigue can limit resource mobilization despite strong technical outputs.
- Speed matters: Short, focused assessments are highly valued in crisis settings; clear roles and surge capacity are critical for success.

- **Political Agreements and Stabilization:**

- Securing political agreements early with relevant players on the ground is key for stabilization programming. UNDP can integrate stabilization as a core programmatic pillar to open space for governance and recovery.
- Flexible funding and streamlined procurement processes may help rapid action. In Haiti, UNDP can further consider adopting stabilization-like approaches in adjacent areas to prevent and/or stop gang territorial control expansion.
- Anticipation mattered. Preparing stabilization plans in advance positions UNDP for quick action and donor engagement when conditions allow.

- **Innovation and Preparedness:** Tools like 3D mapping and remote sensing remain valuable for advocacy and preparedness for stabilization programming. The Haiti experience can serve as a model for other conflict-affected contexts.

- **Cross-cutting technical expertise:**

- The Haiti response demonstrated the added value of mobilizing cross-cutting technical expertise as part of corporate crisis support.
- Regular engagement and complementary expertise helped ensure timely technical advice, consistent application of corporate gender standards, stronger programme design, and more effective support to resource mobilization and institutional strengthening efforts throughout the crisis response. This experience highlights the importance of integrating such expertise early in future crisis responses.
- Strong coordination between the Country Office, Regional Gender Team and HQ Gender Team enhanced the effectiveness of gender-responsive crisis support.
- Institutional mechanisms help sustain gender-responsive crisis programming. The Gender Equality Seal, the Gender Equality Seal Crisis Track and the Haiti Gender Equality Strategy provided practical frameworks for strengthening Country Office

capacity and sustaining gender equality commitments beyond individual projects and funding proposals.

- Gender expertise should be mobilized from the onset of a crisis response and maintained throughout recovery efforts. Early and sustained engagement helps identify context-specific entry points, strengthen programme design, improve proposal quality and support more inclusive stabilization, recovery and resilience programming.

Recommendations

Country Office

- Stabilization in Haiti remains urgent and feasible if GSF Haitian National Police and Armed Forces of Haiti liberate areas from gang control. UNDP's readiness investments should be leveraged immediately when entry points emerge, with rapid activation protocols and strong political backing to demonstrate impact and attract further support.
 - Include stabilization as key pillar in UNDP's programmatic offer.
 - Political Agreements: Secure commitments from GSF, Haitian National Police, Armed Forces of Haiti and donors for area control before deployment.
 - Stabilization-like activities or pre-stabilization initiatives: Develop activities in adjacent areas to stop gang expansion.
 - Integrated DDR: Pair stabilization with disarmament and reintegration pathways to break cycles of violence.

Regional Bureau for Latin America

- Continue and define support to the Haiti CO under the protracted category, jointly with CB, that integrates relevant corporate support and that pulls together different corporate support tools for the CO (TRAC 3, FW, SURGE, ad-hoc RM opportunities and triggering special measures).
- Continue providing dedicated technical advisory support on gender equality throughout the protracted crisis phase, including quality assurance of programme documents, strategic advice during programme design, and support to resource mobilization to strengthen gender-responsive crisis programming.

Crisis Bureau

- Continue and define support to the Haiti CO under the protracted category, jointly with RBLAC, that integrates relevant corporate support and that pulls together different corporate support tools for the CO (TRAC 3, FW, SURGE, ad-hoc RM opportunities and triggering special measures).
- Organize a UNDP internal senior management level discussion on centralization vs decentralization of operational procedures in crisis and protracted contexts. Ensure that future corporate crisis response mechanisms systematically mobilize gender expertise from the onset of a crisis and throughout preparedness, response, stabilization, recovery and resource mobilization processes.

- Define the elements of the protracted category in the SOPs, linked to the ongoing consultations on the Crisis Offer, including:
 - Corporate support for protracted crisis countries that ensure continuous engagement (flexible funding, reduction of layers, and support on domestic revenue partnerships)
 - Expanding special measures to the protracted category.
 - Advocacy to ensure crisis and protracted countries receive higher-level corporate attention
 - Human Resources analysis of COs in protracted contexts.

BMS

- Review and adapt the special measures for (I) increased flexibility under leveled crisis declaration and (II) expanding beyond leveled crisis to include protracted crises.

BERA

- Initiate a coordinated and strategic political engagement with key international partners to align approaches on Haiti, leveraging UNDP's representation capacities in Washington D.C. and other relevant global and regional platforms. This should be undertaken in close coordination with RBLAC, ensuring alignment with regional political dynamics, UNDP's programmatic engagement, and broader UN system efforts in Haiti.

Annexes:

Methodology

This AAR was conducted as a qualitative, learning-focused exercise aimed at capturing operational, strategic, and managerial insights from UNDP's corporate response to the Haiti L3 crisis. The review draws on a desk review of key internal documents, including Crisis Board records, mission ToRs and reports, programmatic and operational guidance issued during the response. This was complemented by semi-structured interviews with UNDP personnel directly involved in the response at CO, RBLAC and CB. Interviewees were selected to reflect a range of functional perspectives, including management, programme, operations, partnerships, communications, and deployments. A list of interviewees is provided below.

Findings were organized around what worked well, where improvements are needed, and lessons learned, with attention to distinguishing context-specific observations from insights of broader institutional relevance. The AAR is not an evaluation and does not assess outcomes or impact against predefined indicators. Rather, it is intended to support institutional learning by capturing practical experience and identifying actionable insights to inform future UNDP responses in political transition and complex crisis contexts.

List of Key Informant Interviewees

	Name	Title	Business Unit
1	Xavier Michon	Resident Representative	Haiti CO
2	Sylvain Merlen	Deputy Resident Representative	Haiti CO
3	Olivier Guillot Hidalgo	Country Oversight Team, Haiti desk officer	Regional Bureau for Latin America and the Caribbean
4	Devanand Ramiah	Director Crisis Readiness, Response and Recovery Team (C3RT)	Crisis Bureau
5	Massimiliano Tozzi	Programme Specialist, C3RT	Crisis Bureau
6	Anila Qehaja	Team Leader Digital Assessments C3RT	Crisis Bureau
7	Margaux Lecardonnel	Partnerships Specialist, Crisis Bureau	Crisis Bureau
8	Glaucia Boyer	Senior Global Advisor Stabilization, C3RT	Crisis Bureau
9	Cristino Pedraza	SURGE Deployment Stabilization and Rapid Crisis Impact Assessment	